

Shalaka Sonawane

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SUMMARY

Software Developer with experience building scalable web applications, microservices, and AI/ML systems. Skilled in RESTful APIs, cloud-native DevOps, and automated testing, with hands-on expertise in generative AI, and prompt engineering to deliver intelligent, high-performing, and secure solutions. Strong foundation in DSA, OOP, and SDLC best practices.

EDUCATION

University of Southern California | Master of Science in Computer Science **August 2023 – May 2025**

Analysis of Data Structures & Algorithms, Database systems, Web Technology, Multimodal Probabilistic Learning of Human Communication, Information Retrieval and Web Search Engine, Security Systems, Software Engineering

University of Mumbai | Bachelor of Engineering in Information Technology **August 2019 – May 2023**

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Frameworks: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, Flask, Next.js, React

Databases & Cloud: SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL), NoSQL (MongoDB), Google Cloud Platform, AWS

AI/ML tools: scikit-learn, Sentence Transformers, TensorFlow, LLM (Gemini API)

DevOps & Tools: Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD pipelines, Power BI, Git

Methodologies: Agile (Scrum), Code Reviews, Automation testing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern (IT Operations) **May 2024 – August 2024**

Tarsus Pharmaceuticals | Irvine, California

- Built internal web application and RESTful APIs to automate IT asset tracking, **reducing manual errors by 30%**.
- Re-architected Configuration Management Database (CMDB) with new data models and real-time Power BI dashboards, improving tracking accuracy by **25%** and speeding incident response.
- Led API QA with Postman, ensuring **reliable deployments** across IT operations by resolving backend data flow issues with proactive communication across cross-functional teams.

Web Developer Intern **January 2023 – May 2023**

AXtechnosoft | Gurgaon, HR, India

- Delivered dynamic, responsive, and reusable React components with Bootstrap, ensuring cross-browser compatibility and WCAG-aligned UI, **boosted site performance by 35%**.
- Integrated APIs and async data flows using Axios, enhancing customer-facing experience and driving **20% higher engagement**.
- Drove maintainability with modular UI patterns, code reviews and debugging.

PROJECTS

CareerLens – AI powered Career Coach **August 2025**

- Designed and developed an AI-powered career coaching platform with OAuth authentication, offering resume optimization, interview preparation, and industry insights through personalized LLM-driven guidance.
- Applied prompt engineering with Gemini 1.5 to generate tailored interview questions, resume enhancements, and cover letters, reducing editing time by **70% in testing** while delivering AI responses in **under 2 seconds**.
- Tech Stack: Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Tailwind CSS, Node.js API Routes, Gemini 1.5 LLM

Event Ease – Seamless Ticketing and Elevated Event Experiences **February 2025 – April 2025**

- Engineered a full-stack event management platform with role-based access, HTTPS encryption, QR-based ticket validation, and real-time analytics, ensuring secure ticketing and **100% accuracy** in simulated scan tests.
- Implemented AI-driven features including a Dialogflow chatbot, attendance predictor, and dynamic pricing engine; applied ML with Sentence Transformers to reduce simulated event errors by **40%**, while automating deployment with Docker, Kubernetes, and CI/CD pipelines on GCP for reliable scalability.
- Tech Stack: React, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Sentence Transformers, Scikit-learn, Dialogflow, Docker, Kubernetes

Stock Market – Web App **February 2024 – April 2024**

- Built a responsive web application enabling real-time stock tracking, portfolio management, sentiment analysis and financial insights, resulting in a seamless user experience and boosting data-driven decision-making.
- Designed RESTful web services in Node.js/Express.js to aggregate Finnhub data with server-side pagination, input validation, and rate limiting; deployed on GCP via CI/CD for scalable, secure software deployment with monitoring.
- Tech Stack: Typescript, Angular, MongoDB, Node.js, Express.js, Finnhub API, HighCharts, GCP

Handwritten Digit Recognition – Machine Learning **October 2023 – November 2023**

- Trained and optimized a Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) with TensorFlow and PyTorch on the MNIST dataset, achieving **98% test accuracy**, applied Pandas for preprocessing and exploratory data analysis.
- Deployed the trained model via a Flask backend with a simple GUI, enabling real-time digit recognition and demonstrating ML applications in banking security, automated form processing, and smart classrooms
- Tech Stack: Python, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Pandas, Numpy, Flask, Streamlit, MNIST Dataset